

Project Cafe

According to rumours, Nintendo's upcoming console called Project Cafe or Wii2 will have an 8-button Wii controller with a 6.2-inch screen and expected to release by October

Samsung fights back

Samsung has filed 10 lawsuits against Apple for infringing the formers mobile patents in as many as three countries

HD-DTH test

the present recording or schedule the other recording after the previous recording. It allows you to watch one channel while recording another. This is just bad for a digital video recorder, specially when its competitors are allowing that.

The remote control is well laid out with neat arrangement of navigational buttons and shortcuts. It does not take much time getting used to.

The HD- DTH players Airtel Digital TV (HD)

The user interface for this version is similar to previous ones, with white text on a black background and red colour highlighting the selected menu. The remote can broadly be divided into three sections viz.shortcuts, navigational pad and numberpad. Favourites allows you to have upto four profiles with about 15 channels in each profile just like Videocon d2h. Live button brings on the Airtel live services. We liked the 'Whats on now' option which brings up a list of genres, and on selecting a particular genre, it will enlist the programs in that genre which are playing currently. This is a unique feature offered only on Airtel.

Interactive services offered have a boring GUI which pixillates. iGoodlife has programming from NDTV Good Times which is divided into Health, Lifestyle, etc which is great for lifestyle TV enthusiasts. But we noticed that the audio starts playing while the screen is still loading for iGoodlife and iDarshan which is weird. There is no lagging between the audio and video though. Implementation of changing of audio languages is quite good.

It has some widgets, which frankly occupy considerable space on the TV and are not that good looking either. Games are also passable, nothing great there. It gives you a preview while channel surfing. We really liked ease of setting up Reminders and Favourites. You can get program information for upto a week from the moment you are watching, but electronic program guide is not impressive.

The remote control is quite well built with a range of shortcut buttons in the top half.

It offers upto three HD channels such as Nat Geo HD, Discovery HD World and Movies Now.



35 HD CHANNELS – REALLY?

The simple answer is : NO! Although Dish TV can claim 35 HD channels, the truth is that they currently offer the least amount of HD channels. What they do offer is up-scaled SD channels, or basically do the work of upscaling before transmitting, which is what your HDTV at home does for every normal SD channel anyway, in order to display it at 1080p/1080i resolutions. We're actually surprised no one has filed a PIL about this already, since it's obviously misleading to tell the public that you offer a service that you obviously do not.

Of their bouquet of HD channels,only Discovery HD World, National Geographic, Doordarshan, Travel XP HD are proper HD channels. Only "Zee Cinema HD" was marginally better picture quality than "Zee Cinema", but still obviously not 1080i HD. Also, none of the channels that Dish TV has misrepresented as HD, carry the HD tag in their logo – not even Zee TV!

Dish TV Tru HD

User interface of Dish TV TruHD is the same as its previous iterations. There was a noticeable delay on changing channels which is not desirable. One thing that we liked in the interface was that it gives you the time remaining on the present program. The main menu has a small screen to the right which gives you a small preview of the channel running in the background. It



is divided into Guide, Active Series, My Dish Space, My Stuff and Setup. Guide contains all the various genres, on entering which you will get a list of channels in that segment, along with a preview. My Stuff gives you a folder which has information regarding your Reminders and Favourites. Setup allows you to add Parental settings (basically locking/unlocking channels).



DIGITAL VIDEO RECORDING PERFORMANCE

Brand	Tata	Reliance	Videocon
Model	Tata Sky + HD	Digital TV (HD DVR)	d2h 3D HD DVR
Scores Out of 100	95.05	52.51	70.81
Recording another channel whilst watching one channel (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y
Recording multiple channels (Y/N)	Y	N	Y
Seeking on recorded material (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y
Hard Disk capacity (GB)	500	160	160
Hours of recording	625	200	200
Series Linking	Y	N	Y
Maximum review buffer (mins)	90	30	120
Max capable recording time before and after recorded programs (So 10)	7	6	7
Protection for recorded programs	Y	Y	Y
Recording directly from the program guide	Y	Y	Y
How many clicks to set series link	2	NA	4
How many clicks to set recorded program to play	2	3	3
Dedicated Record button	Y	Y	Y
Dedicated Button to take you to recorded material	Y	Y	N

Airtel Digital TV has the most value for money pricing for channels offered. This won it the Best Buy

The placement of buttons on the remote control will take a bit of getting used to. The four way arrow keys are placed very close to the Games button, many a times we accidentally pressed Games instead of the down arrow button. The down arrow button is huge trapezoid below which is the rectangular